identities. Everything participates in the nature of everything else.

Human problems start when we just think of ourselves as isolated individuals with social identities confronting a separate material environment. The point of religious practice is the recovery of one's true identity as *Shiva* through the expansion of one's conscious energy. Somananda criticises ***Advaita Vedantins*** who think that the differentiated cosmos is an illusory manifestation (*vivarta*) brought about by mysterious ignorance, of the static, featureless Supreme Reality (***Brahman***). He attacks the idealism of the Buddhist ***Vijnanavada*** that admits streams of consciousness but regards our experience of the material world as merely subjective imagination. Moreover, Buddhists cannot allow that there is a stable subject doing the imagining. Commonsense realists are criticised for admitting individual centres of consciousness and agency, but distinguishing them from their physical environments in such a way that no sense can be made of their relation to it. ***Shaiva Siddhantins*** are castigated for positing themselves as individuals independent of godhead.

Further reading: Sanderson 1990; Torella 2002

Spanda: Kashmiri theological articulation of the view that god is ultimately to be understood as single, creative consciousness. This outlook becomes one of the components of ***Abhinavagupta***'s syncretistic ***Trika***. The 'Verses on Oscillation' (*Spanda Karika*) are alternatively considered to have been composed been composed by *Vasugupta* (850–900 CE) or by his pupil *Kallata*. They are the subject of a commentary (*Spanda Nirnaya*) by the ***Trika*** theorist *Kshemaraja* (1000–50 CE). There is also a commentary (*Spanda Pradipika*) from the point of view of a *Vishnu* cult by *Utpala Vaishnava* (925–75 CE). The